

Lifestyle: A hanumen can fit in anywhere, be comfortable at any task, and is at home in the country and the city, but always seems a little restless. Should they get involved in the politics of the Shinma, they are inevitably a force for change, for chaos seems to follow in their wake. They have little care for the station of others, giving respect only when it is merited, and only if the hanumen in question feels like it.

Fortune: Earth

Luck: Seemingly driven as they are to meddle in the affairs of others, it is fortunate that the hanumen are especially gifted at getting themselves out of trouble. With a Charisma + Empathy roll (difficulty 6), a hanumen can calm the enraged, soothe the furious, and generally keep themselves from receiving what is probably a well-deserved beating.

Curse: For all that they are skilled with wordplay, hanumen rarely seem to think before they speak. All Etiquette rolls are made at +2 difficulty.

Wani Powers: All Athletics rolls for jumping and climbing receive two extra dice, as do all Larceny rolls.

heng po

The heng po swim through the river of life, surfacing to take a peek at the world around them only when it suits them before returning to the water that sustains them. They are often considered unreliable and unpredictable, but nonetheless a source of great knowledge and wisdom. Distractible, disorganized, and given to embellishment, heng po are hoarders writ supreme, keeping their treasures close and hiding them.

Appearance: In their hotei form, most heng po are sleek of body, though their noses are often quite wide and flat, and their hands and eyes are slightly larger than usual. Their animal form usually appears as a carp or other large fish. In wani form, the heng po glisten with iridescent scales that line most of their body, leaving bare only their face, which, in male heng po, sports long whiskers that they take great pride in. The Mask of Shintai renders them horrifying creatures from the deep, massive and slimy with a fanged maw that seems large enough to devour a man whole.

Lifestyle: Heng Po almost always live on or near the water. Small boats that serve as homes are still common among the southern coast of China, especially among the Tanka people, and heng po fit in well here. Even those who forsake quick access to the sea still center themselves in a community, making them well placed to hear (and pass on) gossip.

Fortune: Water

Luck: The heng po are especially gifted at finding things that are lost. Any roll made for that purpose receives a 2-dice bonus.

Curse: Heng Po often find it especially difficult to give up something they truly value from their vast collections. Doing so requires the player to spend a Willpower point.

Wani Powers: Heng Po can breathe freely underwater in their wani form, and suffer no Perception penalties for murky

water or darkness, above or below ground. In addition, their scales add two points of natural Armor.

Nyan

Responsible for folktales of spiritual and demonic cats across Asia, a nyan may, at times, resemble any of them, depending exclusively on her mood. Fickle, self-interested, and commonly driven to excess, other Shinma may think of nyan as lazy and unable to evince even the slightest wisp of discipline. They are not necessarily wrong, but they ignore the nyan at their peril, for these cats are smarter than they seem; indeed, they're too clever by half. A nyan prefers to have things just the way she likes them, and is well equipped to ensure that she gets just that.

Appearance: Nyan are typically well groomed and fit, running to naturally lithe bodies. When they can, they cultivate long nails, and take particular care of their teeth and hair. In animal form, they may be any sort of small cat from the domestic to the wild, though they typically are a touch larger than their breed would normally be. Their wani form blends the two, ears pricked and snout full of razor-sharp teeth, claws stowed safely away until needed. When she employs the Mask of Shintai, the nyan becomes a terrifying predator out of the primal depths of legend, a toothsome beast with long claws that is seemingly just about to pounce on the unfortunate onlooker.

Lifestyle: Nyan prefer to be taken care of, in one way or another, and so frequently glom onto others. Whether they do this as a feline or a human depends entirely on the nyan's preferences, though most find that having opposable thumbs is a benefit they enjoy far too much to give up. More often than not, a nyan born in the countryside emigrate to the cities, where she has more opportunities to bend others to her will, and more chances to vanish into the crowd should she overplay her hand.

Fortune: Fire

Luck: The nyan are blessed with the gift of words and joy, and receive two bonus dice for any rolls associated with making a first impression.

Curse: Nyan are not best pleased with boredom — work and duty, naturally, are counted as quite boring. If something catches the nyan's attention while she is occupied doing something tedious or uninteresting, the player must roll Willpower (difficulty 8). If the roll fails, the nyan abandons the task and follows her fancy.

Wani Powers: Nyan possess sharp claws in this form that inflict (Strength + 1) lethal damage. Both her Perception and her Dexterity increase by 1 as well.

Tanuki

The raccoon dogs of East Asia are often mistaken by Westerners for badgers or raccoons, but though they fill a similar niche in the wild, they are a distinct and unique species, and their spirit cousins, the tanuki, are not apt to let others forget it. Confrontational and given to practical jokes, tanuki can sometimes be hard to get along with, but when push comes to shove and violence is on the line, no one is likelier to come to